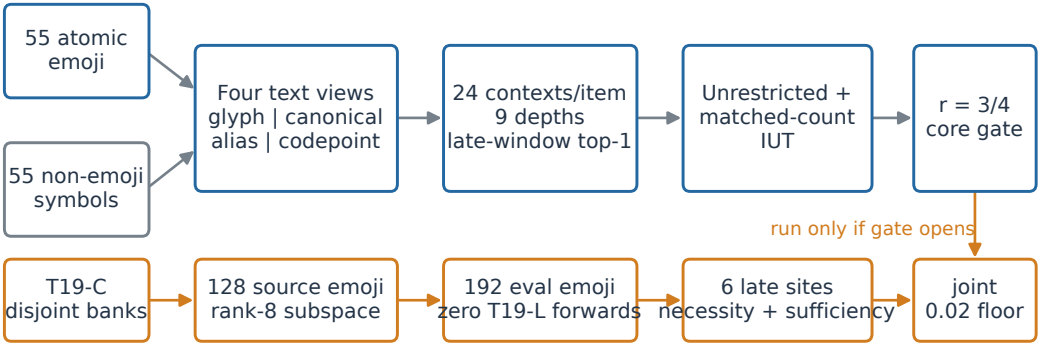T19-L: frozen observational gate